

Test Cookbook

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RECIPES

1. Zesty Lemon Garlic Shrimp Pasta	3
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Zesty Lemon Garlic Shrimp Pasta

SERVINGS: 4

PREP: 10 MIN

COOK: 20 MIN

Ingredients

400 g spaghetti

500 g large raw shrimp,
peeled and deveined

4 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

4 cloves garlic, thinly sliced

1/2 tsp red pepper flakes

120 ml dry white wine

3 tbsp unsalted butter

1 lemon, zested and juiced
(about 3 tbsp juice)

1/2 tsp fine sea salt, plus
more for pasta water

1/4 tsp freshly ground black
pepper

30 g fresh flat-leaf parsley,
roughly chopped

30 g freshly grated
Parmigiano-Reggiano, to
serve

Instructions

- 1 Salt and boil the pasta:** Bring a large pot of water to a rolling boil and season generously with salt. Cook the spaghetti according to package directions until al dente, then reserve 180 ml of the starchy pasta water before draining.
- 2 Season the shrimp:** Pat the shrimp dry with paper towels and season all over with salt and black pepper. Dry shrimp will sear rather than steam, giving you a better colour and texture.
- 3 Sauté the garlic:** Heat the olive oil in a large, wide skillet over medium heat. Add the sliced garlic and red pepper flakes and cook, stirring frequently, for about 2 minutes until the garlic is fragrant and just turning golden at the edges — do not let it brown.
- 4 Cook the shrimp:** Increase the heat to medium-high and add the shrimp in a single layer. Cook for 1–2 minutes per side until pink and just opaque, then transfer the shrimp to a plate and set aside.
- 5 Deglaze and build the sauce:** Pour the white wine into the same skillet and let it bubble for 2 minutes, scraping up any flavourful bits from the bottom of the pan. Stir in the butter, lemon zest, and lemon juice until the butter is fully melted and the sauce looks glossy.
- 6 Toss the pasta:** Add the drained spaghetti to the skillet and toss vigorously over medium heat, adding the reserved pasta water a splash at a time until the sauce clings to every strand. Return the shrimp to the pan and toss again just to warm through.
- 7 Finish and serve:** Remove the skillet from the heat and fold in the chopped parsley. Divide among warmed bowls and finish with a little grated Parmigiano-Reggiano and an extra crack of black pepper.

Tips and Variations

Use fresh, never-frozen shrimp when possible, but if using frozen, thaw them overnight in the fridge and dry them thoroughly before cooking.

For a dairy-free version, swap the butter for an extra 2 tablespoons of good-quality extra-virgin olive oil and a teaspoon of white miso for richness.

Don't skip the starchy pasta water — it emulsifies the sauce and helps it coat the pasta beautifully rather than pooling at the bottom of the bowl.

If you prefer a more intense lemon flavour, add the juice of half a second lemon just before serving and taste as you go.